

Better Secure Than Sorry

The old adage goes "Better safe than sorry," of course. We'd change that to "secure" because of the sheer importance that word has taken on. What used to be money, gold and such is now data, and data cannot be secured using a six-lever padlock.

The purpose of this book is two-fold: to be an eye-opener, and to be a guide. It is our intention to tell you just how vulnerable you are, and we follow that up by telling you what you can do about it.

Admittedly, a lot has been written in *Digit* about viruses and other threats, but (a) we have tried to collate all such information into one handy reference, and (b) we have included here an anti-virus shootout. The biggest security-related threat out there is, of course, The Virus, and anti-virus software is, these days, something your personal computer can't live without. With that in mind, our anti-virus test will help you choose what's right for you. Anti-spyware tools have been discussed in depth as well.

Apart from viruses, adware, spyware, and other "wares", we also talk about how to keep data on your computer secure from other people. It's just a matter of good practice. You never know. And in some cases, it becomes a necessity—as in an office environment.

We also talk about how to keep your local network secure; about how to stay secure when on the Internet, in general; and about safety when on the move.

We should admit that much of what follows may seem to have been written for the paranoid, but paranoia is fast becoming a virtue.